

Philipp Hilbert. *Senior Product Manager for a category-leading productivity product.*

Positioning, 13 years shipping product across regulated industries, B2B SaaS, and AI tooling, now focused on consumer productivity at scale.

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§ WHY READDLE

PDF Expert is used by over 30 million people and has won App of the Year, that is a level of market fit most products never reach. The role sits at the intersection of user value, monetization, and AI-powered workflows across iOS, Mac, and Web, which is exactly the problem space I find most interesting right now. The posting calls out AI prototyping and vibe-coding as a plus, and I use those tools daily. *That combination of real scale and room to push the product forward is rare.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo and spec work
- **GitHub Copilot**, code review and generation
- **Cursor**, editor-level AI refactors
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **Framer**, design and interactive mockups
- **GPT**, research, drafting, edge-case generation
- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation
- **Gamma.app**, fast presentation and doc creation

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Docker, GitOps rollout and rollback, Jenkins, CI/CD pipelines, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), PostgreSQL, MongoDB, REST APIs, Dagster, dbt, ETL pipelines, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro, Azure DevOps, GitLab.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Two-sided B2B marketplace for construction staffing, built solo from zero.

- Matches construction firms with workers, cutting out the headhunter with an anonymity-until-payment model.
 - WhatsApp and Telegram as the product surface, with LLM agents handling funnel automation so one person runs day-to-day operations.
 - Funnel and conversion analysis in SQL; full discovery, spec, and build done alone.
 - Demonstrates the kind of end-to-end ownership and AI-native execution this role asks for.
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§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT READDLE

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Sit with support tickets, App Store reviews, and session recordings for PDF Expert to map where the 30 million users actually hit friction, before touching the roadmap.

WEEK 2

Instrument, then slice.

Pull funnel and retention data across iOS, Mac, and Web to identify which drop-off points are worth an experiment and which are noise.

WEEK 3+

Ship one clear bet.

Scope and align the first initiative: a defined hypothesis, a success metric, and a launch plan the team can execute without ambiguity.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Readdle team,

PDF Expert has 30 million users, App of the Year recognition, and a product that people rely on every day. That is the kind of foundation that makes a PM role interesting, there is real signal in the data, real stakes in every decision, and real room to push the product forward rather than just maintaining it.

I have 13 years of product ownership, most of it in environments where the stakes were high and the complexity was structural: a European defence AI programme with multinational engineering teams, a national labour-market analytics platform, a B2B SaaS insurance platform, and a fintech product taken from zero to acquisition by Sparkasse. Across those roles I owned discovery, roadmap prioritisation, cross-functional alignment, and delivery, the full loop the posting describes.

The AI prototyping angle in this role is a fit, not a talking point. I use Claude Code, Lovable, Cursor, and GitHub Copilot in my daily workflow, for rapid prototyping, spec generation, and edge-case validation. At Rohde & Schwarz I redirected the entire product strategy based on instrumented workflow data: a polished UI recorded zero clicks while the developer-code-first path drove a 200% increase in pipeline runs. That kind of outcome-first thinking, backed by data and a willingness to kill a beautiful thing that doesn't work, is how I approach every product decision.

The posting mentions mobile UX and cross-platform product lifecycle across iOS, Mac, and Web. I have shipped on mobile (patient app on iOS and Android at CLINET Platforms) and managed multi-platform rollout in SAFe environments. I am comfortable with the full product lifecycle from discovery and sizing through execution, launch, and post-launch monitoring.

I would like to bring that combination of analytical rigour, hands-on AI tooling, and cross-functional delivery experience to the PDF Expert team.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ PROFILE

Senior Product Manager with 13 years of product ownership across B2B SaaS, public-sector analytics, AI data platforms, insurance, healthcare, and fintech. I run continuous discovery, turn user needs and technical constraints into a prioritised roadmap, and lead cross-functional teams through agile delivery. I work with data and product metrics from day one of any new role, and I use AI prototyping tools daily.

§ HOW I WORK

- I leave my ego at home. I want to drive the decision, not to have the last word.
 - On a new product I spend a little to learn before spending a lot to build. Cheap experiments make expensive decisions safe(r).
 - Outcome over output. Producing something is not the achievement; it also has to fit a market, so I agree what would count as success before we build and check afterwards whether it happened.
 - I keep the whole value chain in view, not just the backlog. Defect-to-fix time is a product metric; architects and DevOps engineers build that chain, my job is to steer it into the right lanes.
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§ WORK EXPERIENCE

PRODUCT MANAGER, ROHDE & SCHWARZ, MUNICH / REMOTE |
07/2024-05/2025

Defence and aerospace. Internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme.

- Redirected product strategy based on user workflow analysis, increasing pipeline runs by 200% by prioritising developer-code-first over UI-led design.
- Championed GitOps delivery and test automation with ArgoCD, reducing rollout time from days to 30 minutes across multinational teams.
- Led a cross-functional team of 15+ engineers and data scientists through Scrum in Jira and Confluence.

PRODUCT MANAGER, BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT, NUREMBERG /
REMOTE | 05/2023-07/2024

Public sector. National labour-market analytics platform for policymakers and researchers.

- Introduced Dagster and dbt so quarterly imports and new indicators ran without hand-holding, saving almost 75% of the time per data update.
- Migrated a bare-metal system fully into containers and carried a full UI relaunch and a large ETL migration through the same period.

PRODUCT OWNER, CLINET PLATFORMS, BERLIN | 01/2023-07/2023

Healthcare. Mobile patient app for iOS and Android, piloted in hospitals.

- Cut the roadmap to the top 10% of features against agreed success measures: user acceptance rose more than fivefold.
- Integrated the CGM interface into hospital information system workflows, reducing digital anamnesis time from 30 minutes to 5.

PRODUCT MANAGER, EMIL GROUP, BERLIN | 04/2022-12/2022

Insurance. B2B SaaS platform for insurers, reinsurers, brokers and underwriters.

- Restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams: attrition fell from near-total exodus to a single departure.
- Shipped the Claims Center from concept to production and cut time-to-market for new insurance products from months to less than a week.

PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION TEAM, SCHEIDT & BACHMANN,
MÖNCHENGLADBACH | 09/2021-03/2022

Retail and payments. POS and forecourt systems in a fully SAFe setup.

- Moved research results into production across a matrix organisation with agile release trains and PI planning.

PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM), BUNDESDRUCKEREI, BERLIN |
03/2021-06/2021

- Government, secure data platform. Data structures and identity management for the Robert Koch Institute.

PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY), AOK ITSCARE, FRANKFURT | 03/2019-05/2020

- Health insurance, B2B procurement webshop. Migrated a legacy system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and roughly 20,000 employees; still in production.

PROJECT LEAD, ENERCON, WISMAR / MAGDEBURG | 04/2019-12/2019

- Wind energy, full site IT modernisation end to end.

§ FOUNDER TRACK

FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER, CONSTRUCT8, LIMASSOL | 12/2025-PRESENT

- Construction staffing B2B marketplace, built solo. Anonymity-until-payment model, LLM agents across the funnel, SQL-based funnel and conversion analysis.

CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER, QCRYPT AG, BERLIN | 01/2016-12/2021

- IT security, quantum-secure encryption. Shipped a three-layer product that installs in under two minutes for enterprise buyers. Later Chair of the board.

FOUNDER AND CFO, KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS, BERLIN | 02/2013-11/2018

- Fintech, mobile P2P payments. Built from zero and acquired by Sparkasse, operating inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ SKILLS

Product Management: continuous discovery, product roadmap, prioritisation, MVP definition, A/B testing, user research and interviews, prototyping, funnel and churn analysis, KPI definition, product lifecycle management, go-to-market support.

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt and context engineering, AI governance, EU AI Act, Explainable AI (XAI); daily prototyping with Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, and Lovable.

Analytics and Data: funnel and churn analysis, KPI definition, Matomo, MicroStrategy, ETL, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, SQL.

Product Ownership: user stories, acceptance criteria, backlog refinement, sprint planning, velocity and burndown, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Scrum, Kanban, SAFe, ART, PI planning.

Technical Environments Owned: Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Docker, GitOps, CI/CD, Jenkins, Python, Kotlin, REST APIs, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Azure DevOps.

Stakeholder and Leadership: stakeholder management, cross-functional team leadership, C-level reporting, workshop facilitation, conflict resolution.

Governance: GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership.

§ EDUCATION

DIPLOM-WIRTSCHAFTSINGENIEUR (INDUSTRIAL ENGINEERING AND MANAGEMENT, EQUIVALENT TO A MASTER'S DEGREE), TECHNISCHE UNIVERSITÄT BERLIN (TU BERLIN), GERMANY | 10/2006-09/2014

- Specialisation: Logistics. Thesis with Siemens AG Energy Service on balancing-power market profitability.

§ LANGUAGES

German (native speaker, C2) · English (C2, business and technical fluency)

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TRUE NORTH · APPLICATION PACKAGE · READDLE

